Andragogical Inclusion: A Professional Knowledge Exchange

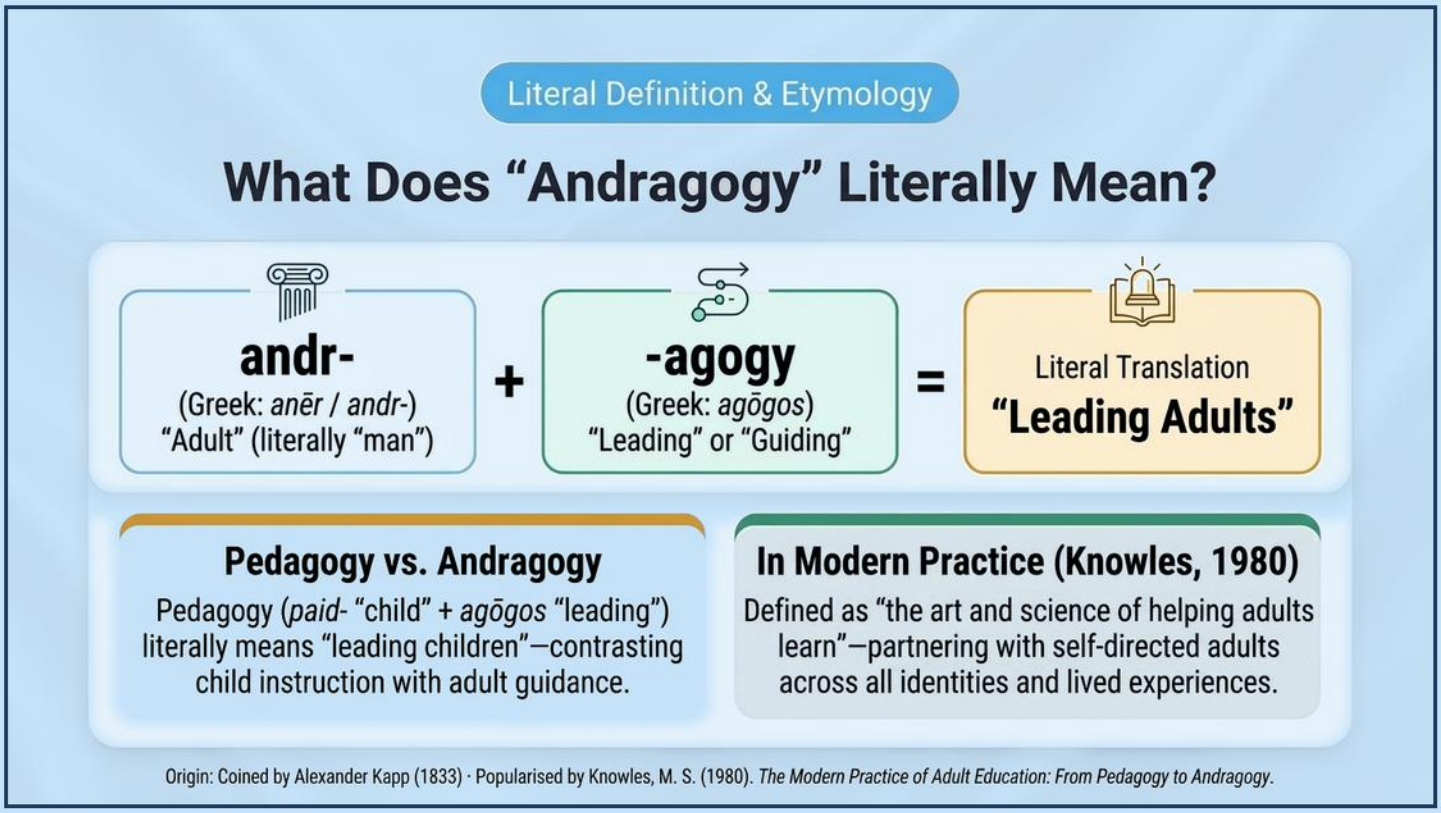


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Andragogical Inclusion: A Professional Knowledge Exchange
- Bridging Lived Experience, Equity, and Academic Rigour in Adult Learning
- Community of Practice — Peer Community: Convening as scholarly practitioners sharing expertise.
- Critical Andragogy — Critical Synthesis: Interrogating where adult learning theory meets social justice.
- Equitable Rigour — Action Horizon: Generating tangible curricular adaptations for next week.

Facilitator Note: Welcome colleagues. Emphasise that this room holds decades of front-line pedagogical wisdom. We are not delivering a deficit-model training session; we are interrogating institutional assumptions together to elevate learning for every adult.

What Does “Andragogy” Literally Mean?

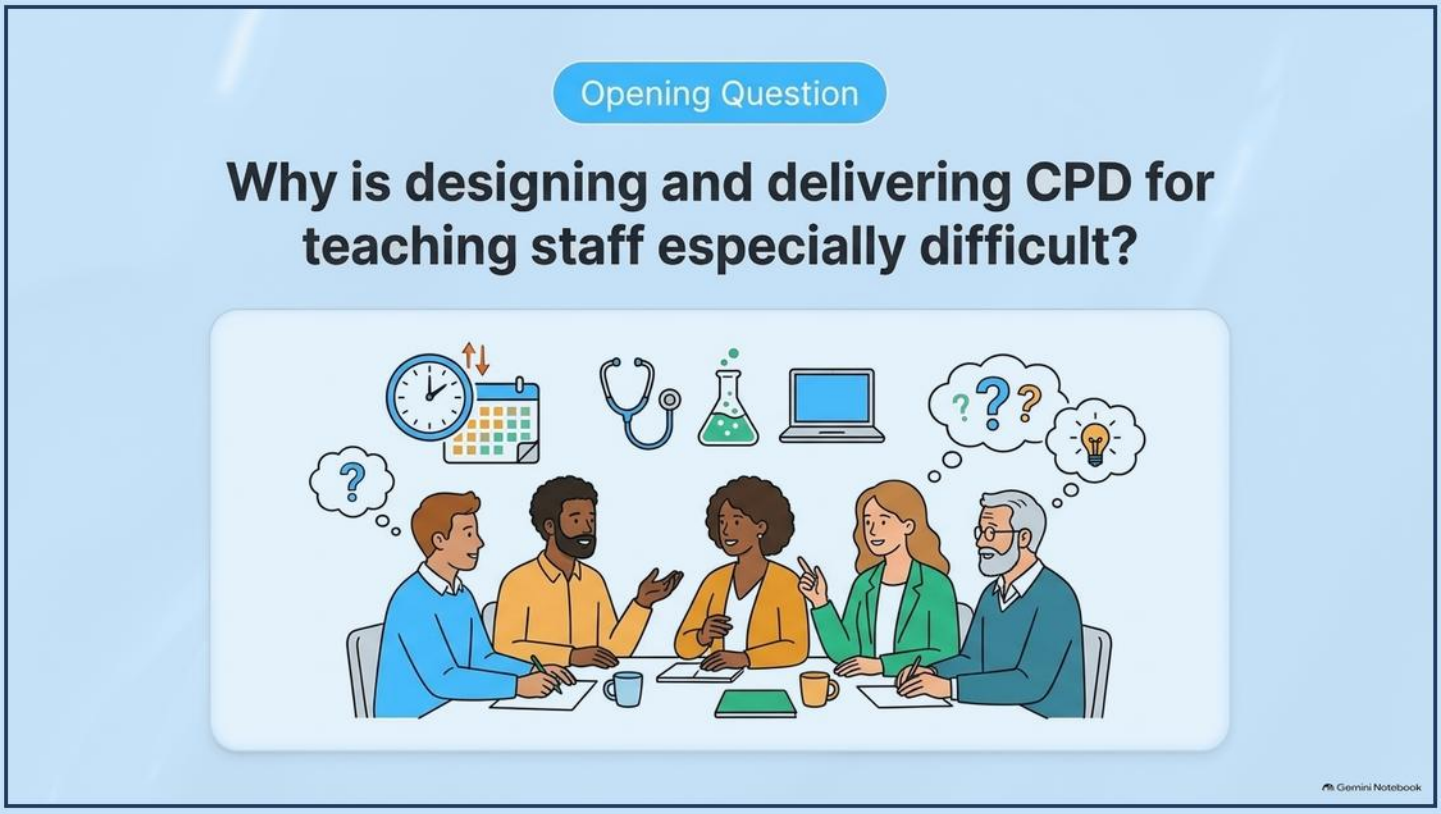


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Literal Definition & Etymology
- What Does “Andragogy” Literally Mean?
- andr- (Greek: anēr / andr-) — “Adult” (literally “man”) + -agogy (Greek: agōgos) — “Leading” or “Guiding” = Literal Translation: “Leading Adults”
- Pedagogy vs. Andragogy: Pedagogy (paid- “child” + agōgos “leading”) literally means “leading children”—contrasting child instruction with adult guidance.
- In Modern Practice (Knowles, 1980): Defined as “the art and science of helping adults learn”—partnering with self-directed adults across all identities and lived experiences.
- Origin: Coined by Alexander Kapp (1833) · Popularised by Knowles, M. S. (1980). The Modern Practice of Adult Education: From Pedagogy to Andragogy.

Facilitator Note: Unpack the literal Greek etymology immediately after our plain-English red-pen translation on Slide 1: 'andr-' (from Greek anēr/andr-, meaning 'adult' or literally 'man') + '-agogy' (agōgos, 'leading' or 'guiding') literally translates to 'leading

Opening Question: Why is designing and delivering CPD for teaching staff especially difficult?

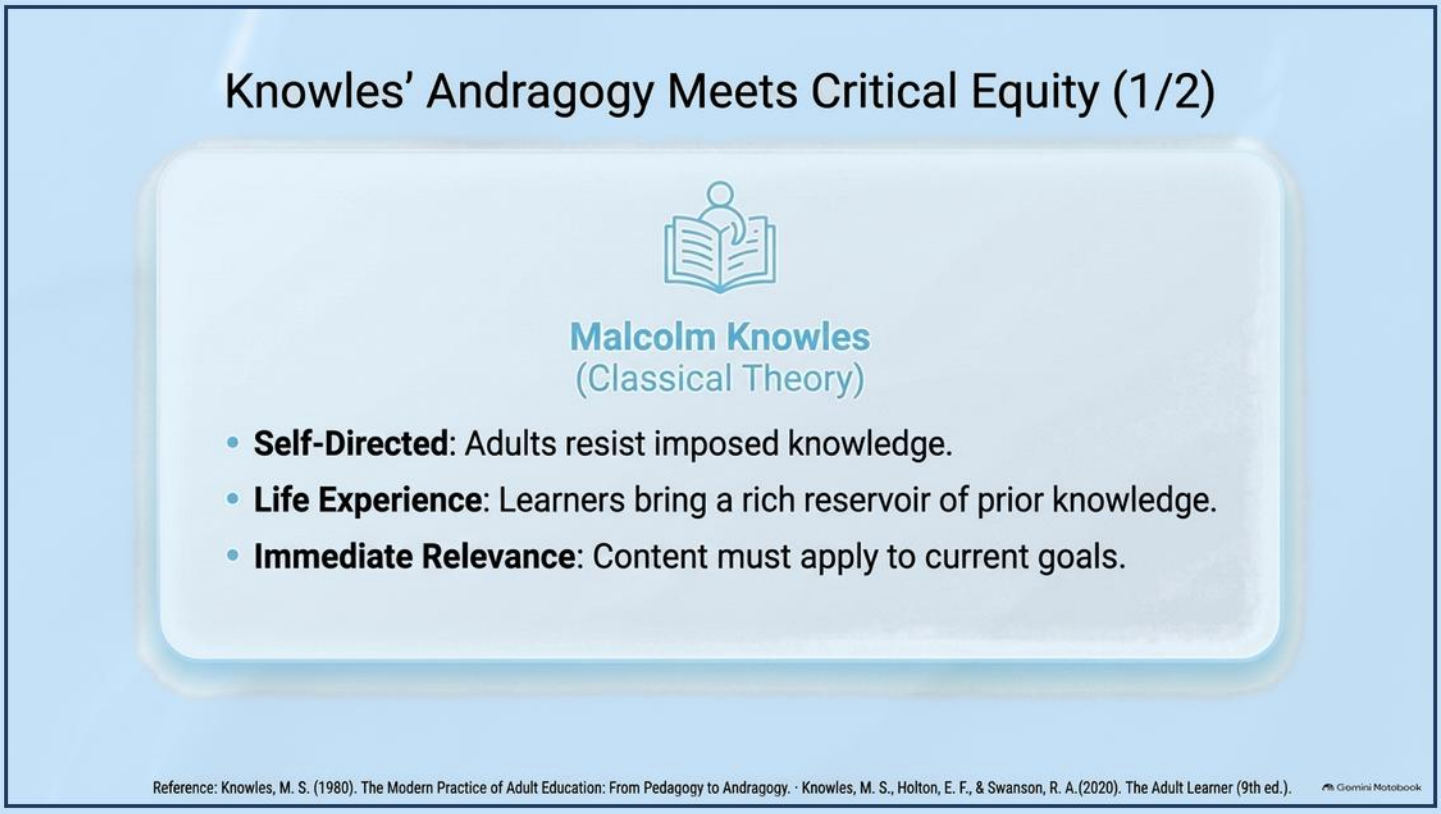


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Opening Question
- Why is designing and delivering CPD for teaching staff especially difficult?

Facilitator Note: Invite brief paired or whole-room reflections. Teaching staff are themselves expert adult learners juggling acute time poverty, diverse disciplinary cultures, and varied career stages—which means generic, top-down compliance training immediately

Knowles' Andragogy Meets Critical Equity (1/2) — Malcolm Knowles (Classical Theory)

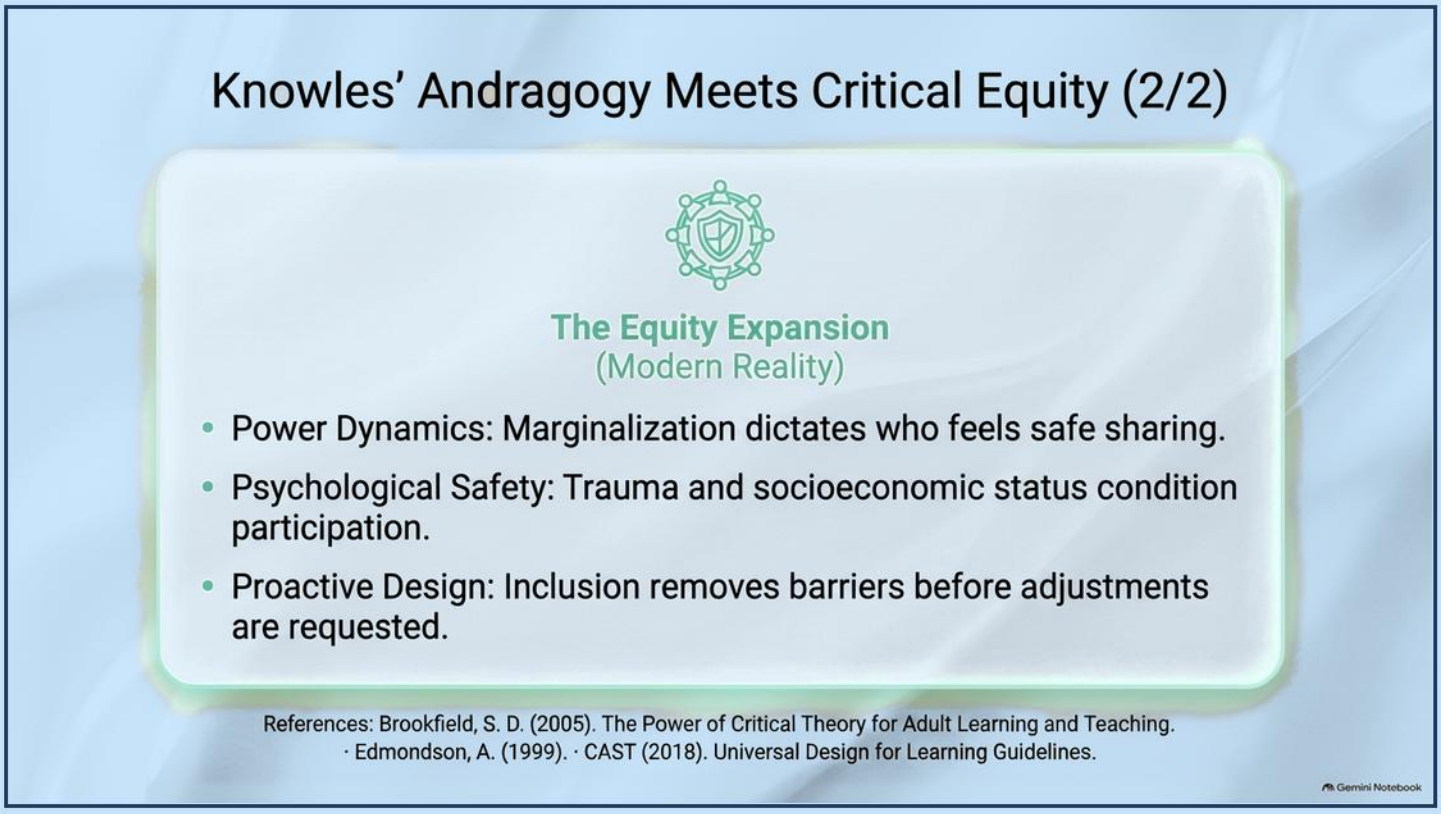


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Knowles' Andragogy Meets Critical Equity (1/2)
- Malcolm Knowles (Classical Theory)
- Self-Directed: Adults resist imposed knowledge.
- Self-direction and learner autonomy quotes: "Would like more time to talk and share experience." · "Open forum to share struggles in the role." · "Talked about what we need, relevant, current." (Key message: There was a clear preference for greater participant-led discussion, peer sharing and opportunities for staff to shape CPD around identified needs.)
- Life Experience: Learners bring a rich reservoir of prior knowledge.
- Life experience and prior knowledge quotes: "Nothing new." · "Take into account prior knowledge." · "We are doing things quite well already." · "Some elements did not offer additional learning as I already do these." (Key message: CPD did not always sufficiently recognise, build upon or extend participants' existing knowledge and professional expertise.)
- Immediate Relevance: Content must apply to current goals.

Facilitator Note: Knowles' classical theory of andragogy centres on three pillars—and our own staff CPD feedback illustrates each one: 1. Self-Direction & Learner Autonomy: "Would like more time to talk and share experience." / "Open forum to share struggles in the role." /

Knowles' Andragogy Meets Critical Equity (2/2) — The Equity Expansion (Modern Reality)

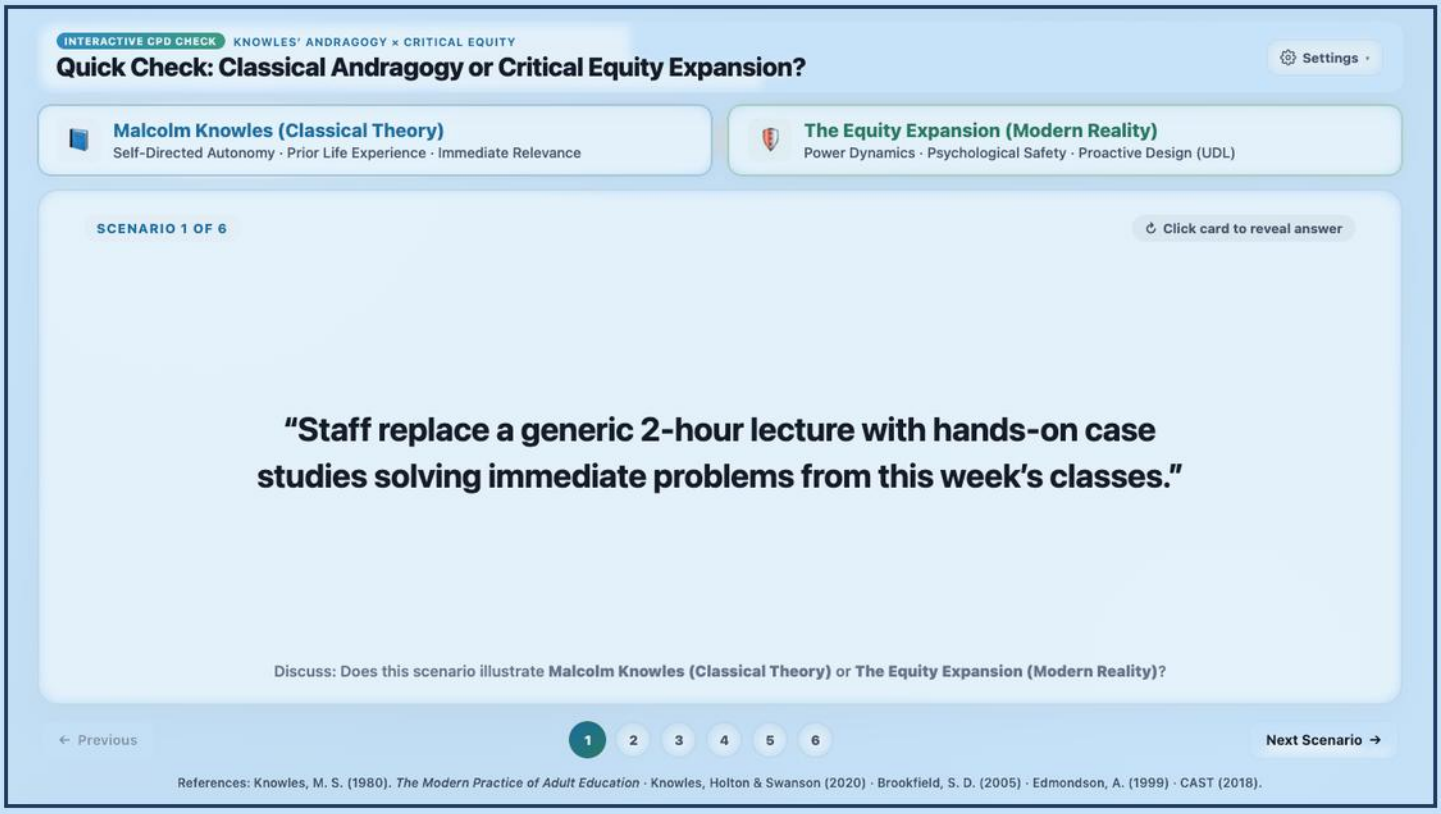


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Knowles' Andragogy Meets Critical Equity (2/2)
- The Equity Expansion (Modern Reality)
- Power Dynamics: Marginalization dictates who feels safe sharing.
- Psychological Safety: Trauma and socioeconomic status condition participation.
- Proactive Design: Inclusion removes barriers before adjustments are requested.
- References: Brookfield, S. D. (2005). The Power of Critical Theory for Adult Learning and Teaching. · Edmondson, A. (1999). · CAST (2018). Universal Design for Learning Guidelines.

Facilitator Note: Knowles assumed an unencumbered, autonomous adult. In modern reality, power dynamics dictate who feels safe sharing (Brookfield, 2005), trauma and socioeconomic precarity condition participation and psychological safety (Edmondson, 1999), and

Quick Check: Classical Andragogy or Critical Equity Expansion?



Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Interactive CPD Check: Knowles' Andragogy × Critical Equity
- Quick Check: Classical Andragogy or Critical Equity Expansion?
- Mode 1 — Lens Classifier (6 Scenarios): Classify real-world adult teaching and CPD scenarios between Malcolm Knowles (Classical Theory: Self-Direction, Life Experience, Immediate Relevance) and The Equity Expansion (Modern Reality: Power Dynamics, Psychological Safety, Proactive Design).
- Mode 2 — Diagnostic Quiz (3 Scenarios): Diagnose why classical adult learning assumptions falter without a critical equity lens and select the inclusive redesign.
- References: Knowles (1980) · Knowles, Holton & Swanson (2020) · Brookfield (2005) · Edmondson (1999) · CAST (2018).

Facilitator Note: Run this 2-minute interactive check with CPD attendees. In Mode 1 (Lens Classifier), invite tables or the whole room to classify each of the 6 teaching scenarios into either Malcolm Knowles' Classical Andragogy or The Equity Expansion, then click

Differentiated Pathways to Practice

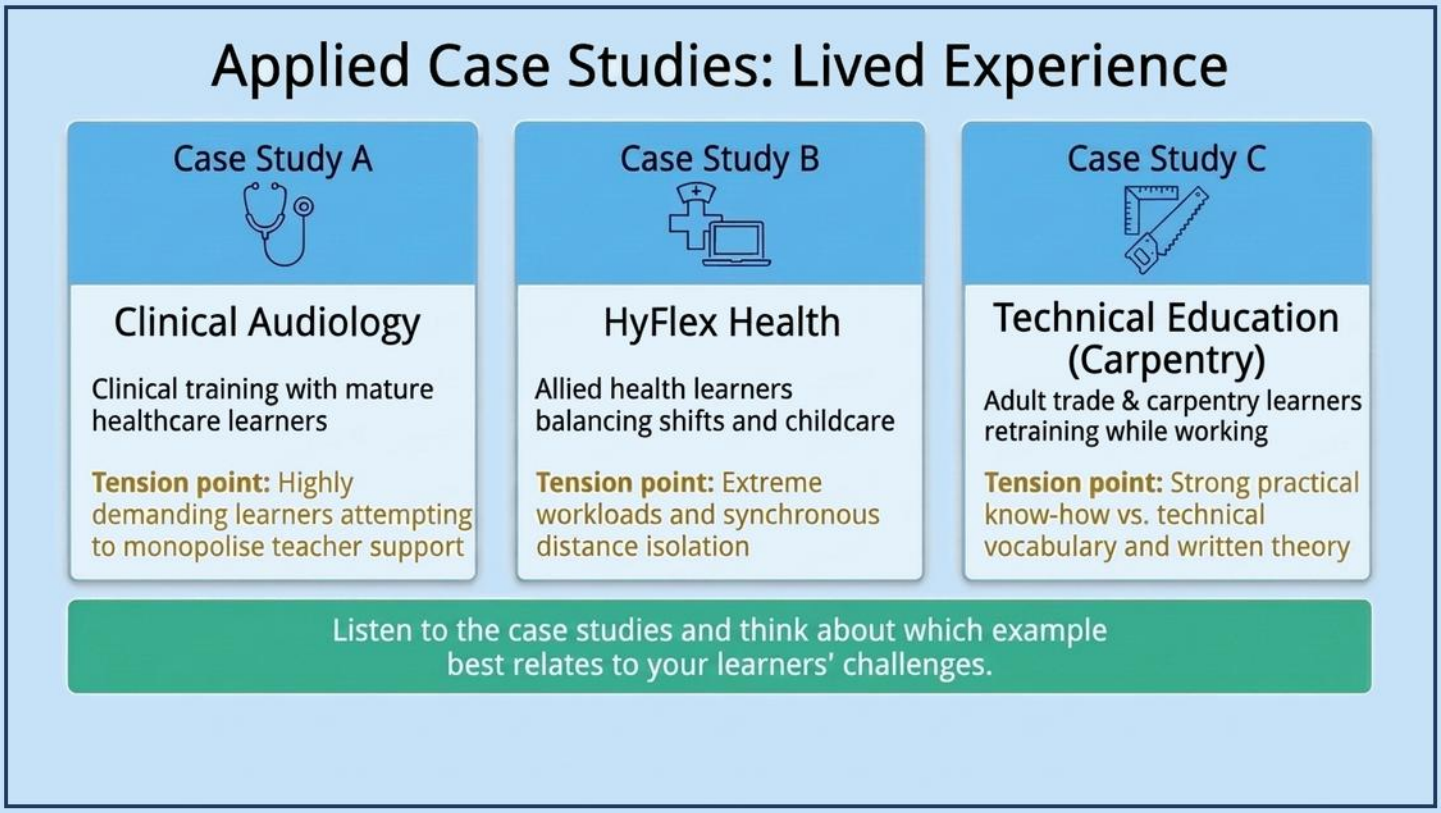


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Differentiated Pathways to Practice
- Developing Practitioners — Focus: Concrete, low-prep inclusive teaching strategies. Action: Embed 2–3 ready-to-use techniques into next week's plan. Goal: Build confidence in proactive universal design.
- Experienced Lecturers — Focus: Complex edge-cases balancing inclusion and professional standards. Action: Design a micro-evaluation to measure a novel adaptation's impact. Goal: Share evidence of curricular adaptation success.

Facilitator Note: Highlight that experienced teachers need space to wrestle with complex edge cases, while newer colleagues benefit from immediate, high-leverage procedural templates.

Applied Case Studies: Lived Experience



Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Applied Case Studies: Lived Experience
- Case Study A — Clinical Audiology: Clinical training with mature healthcare learners. Tension point: Highly demanding learners attempting to monopolise teacher support.
- Case Study B — HyFlex Health: Allied health learners balancing shifts and childcare. Tension point: Extreme workloads and synchronous distance isolation.
- Case Study C — Technical Education (Carpentry): Adult trade & carpentry learners retraining while working. Tension point: Strong practical know-how vs. technical vocabulary and written theory.
- Listen to the case studies and think about which example best relates to your learners' challenges.

Facilitator Note: Invite colleagues to listen to the three lived-experience case studies—Clinical Audiology, HyFlex Health, and Technical Education (Carpentry)—and reflect on which scenario best mirrors their own learners' challenges.

Case Study A (1/4): Making a Cohort

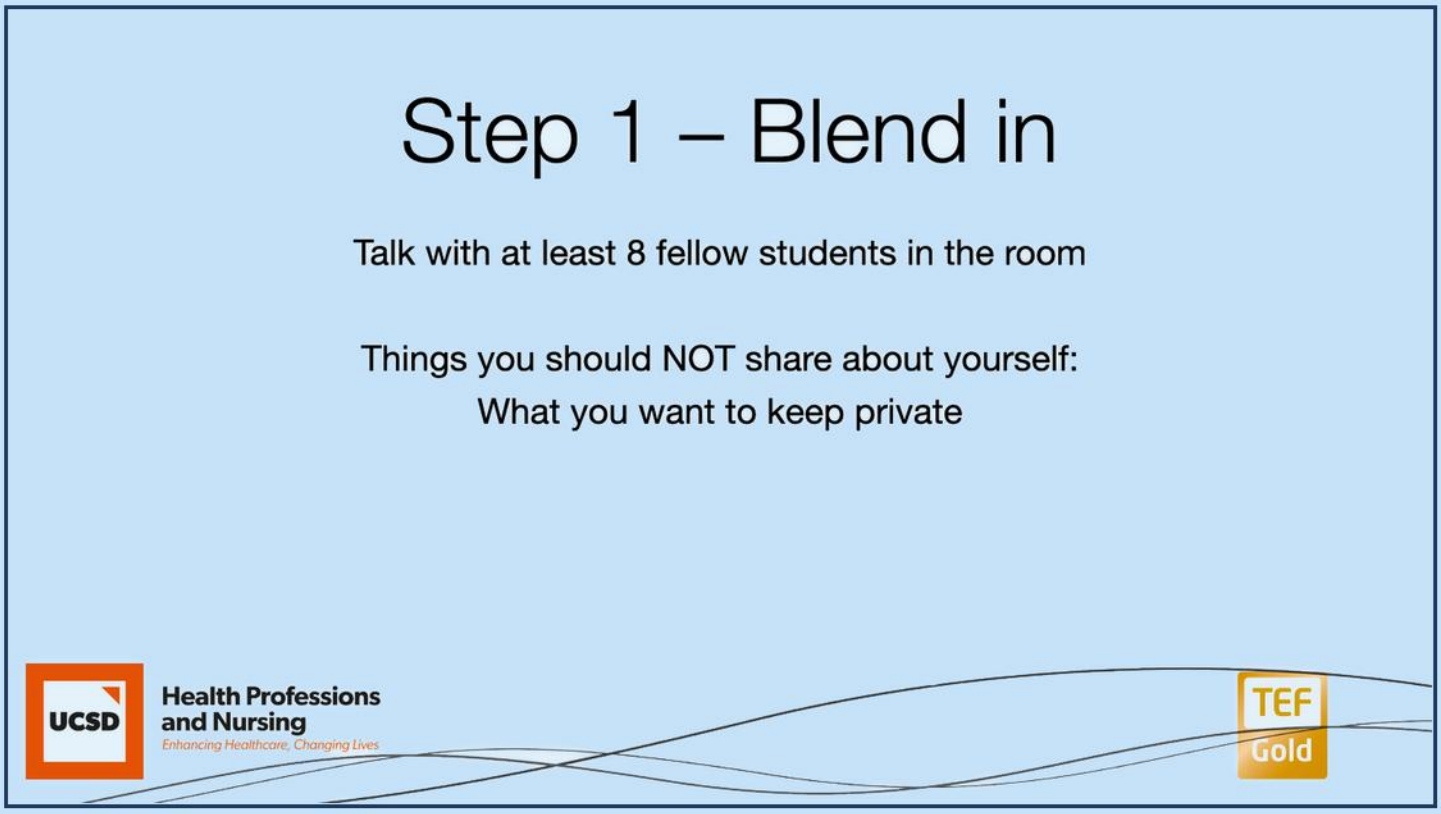


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Making a cohort
- UCSD Health Professions and Nursing — Enhancing Healthcare, Changing Lives

Facilitator Note: Case Study A (1/4): Introduce the clinical audiology and health professions cohort-building protocol ('Making a cohort'), designed to establish psychological safety and peer belonging from Day 1.

Case Study A (2/4): Step 1 – Blend In

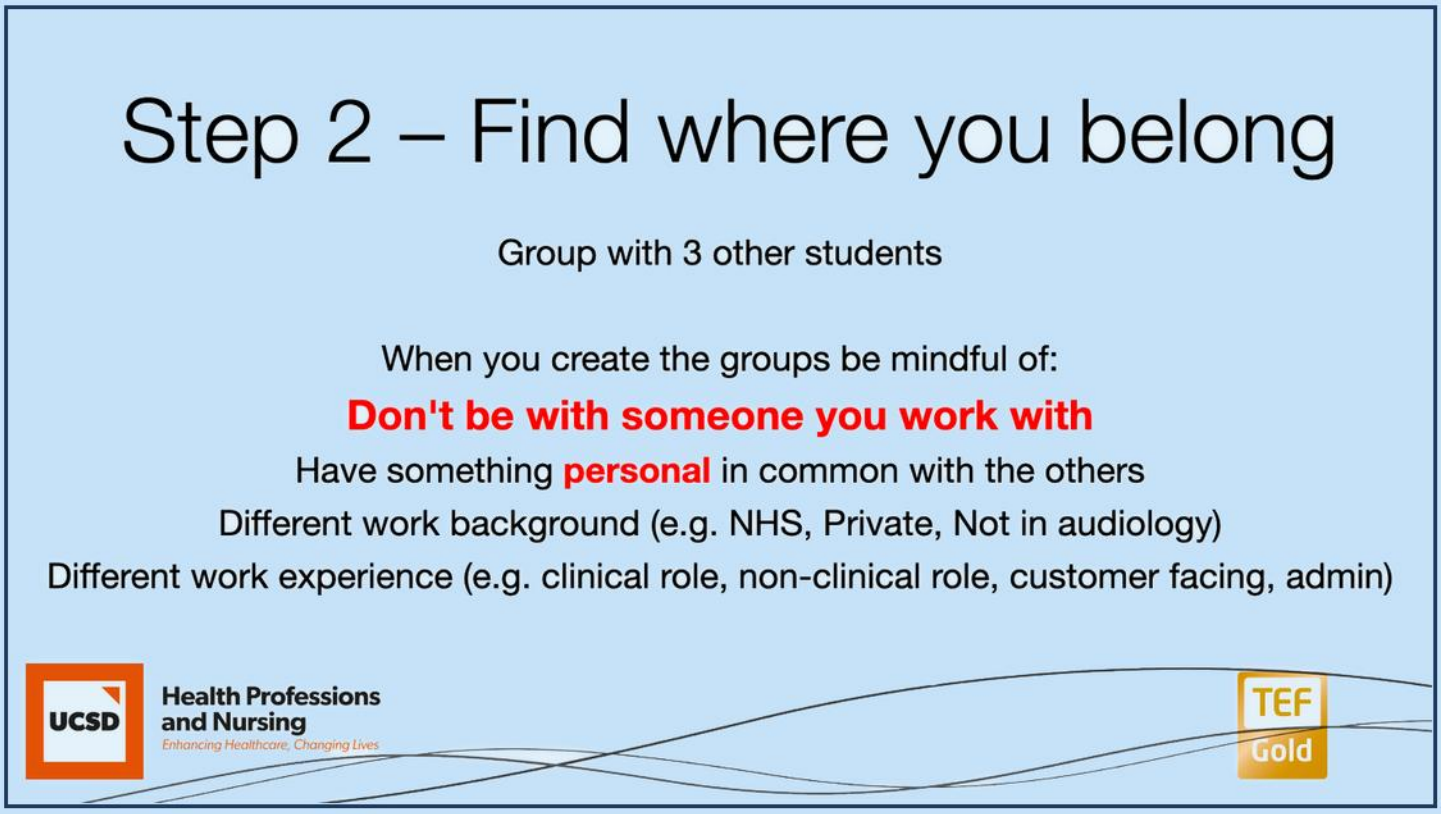


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Step 1 – Blend in
- Talk with at least 8 fellow students in the room
- Things you should NOT share about yourself:
- What you want to keep private

Facilitator Note: Case Study A (2/4): Step 1 – Blend in. Learners speak with at least 8 fellow students in the room while explicitly protecting personal boundaries ('Things you should NOT share about yourself: What you want to keep private').

Case Study A (3/4): Step 2 – Find Where You Belong

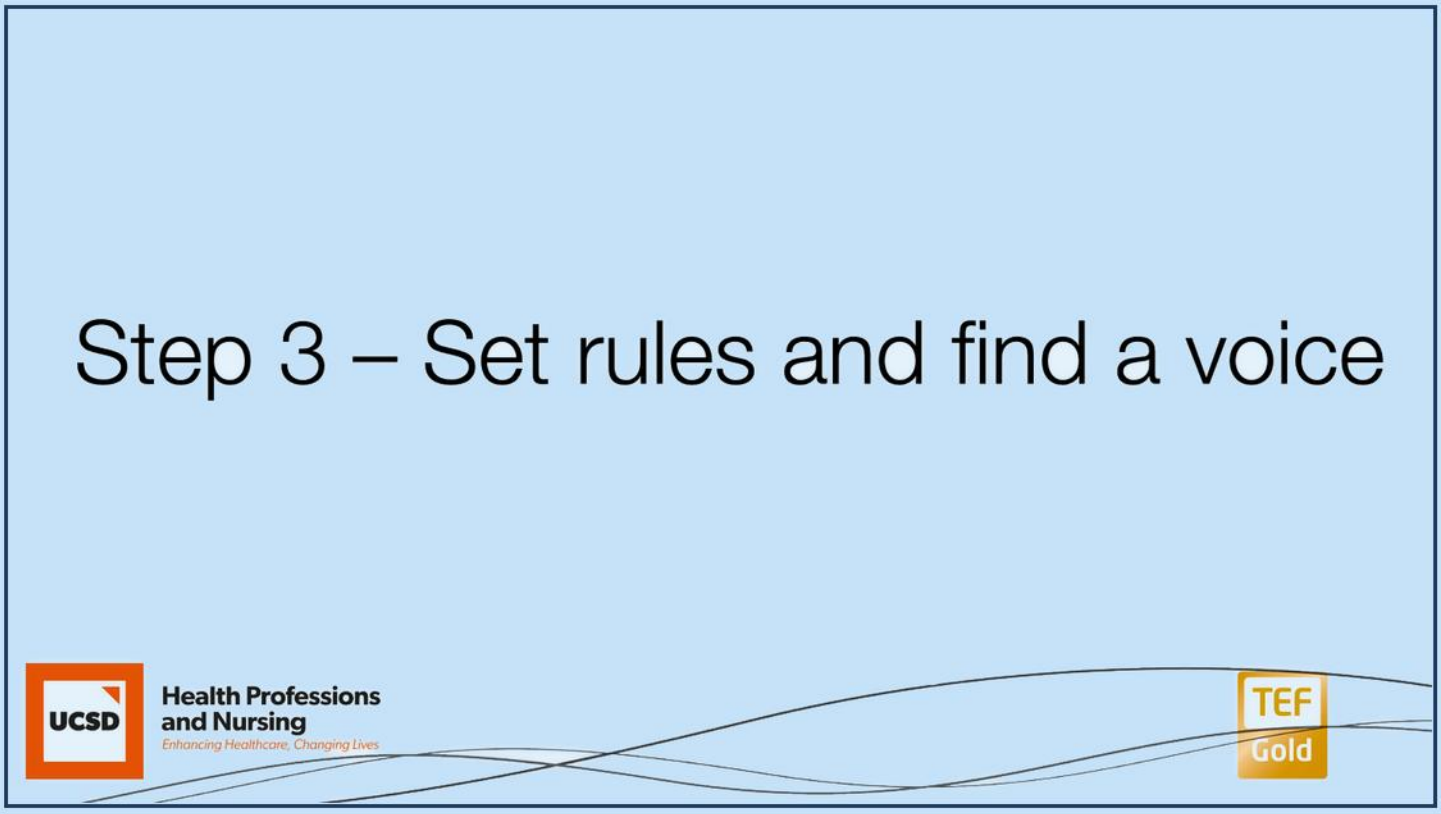


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Step 2 – Find where you belong
- Group with 3 other students
- When you create the groups be mindful of:
- Don't be with someone you work with
- Have something personal in common with the others
- Different work background (e.g. NHS, Private, Not in audiology)
- Different work experience (e.g. clinical role, non-clinical role, customer facing, admin)

Facilitator Note: Case Study A (3/4): Step 2 – Find where you belong. Learners form groups of 4 with colleagues they do not work with, finding something personal in common while intentionally mixing work backgrounds (NHS, Private, Not in audiology) and roles (clinical, non-

Case Study A (4/4): Step 3 – Set Rules and Find a Voice



Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

• Step 3 – Set rules and find a voice

Facilitator Note: Case Study A (4/4): Step 3 – Set rules and find a voice. Groups co-construct their shared ground rules and establish an equitable voice within the cohort before high-stakes clinical and academic activities begin.

Case Study B (1/6): Research Through an Inclusion Lens

Research Through an Inclusion Lens

- Level 7 research exploring apprentice experiences
- Focus on experiences within HyFlex learning
- Adult learners balance work, study and personal responsibilities
- Examined barriers and enablers of success

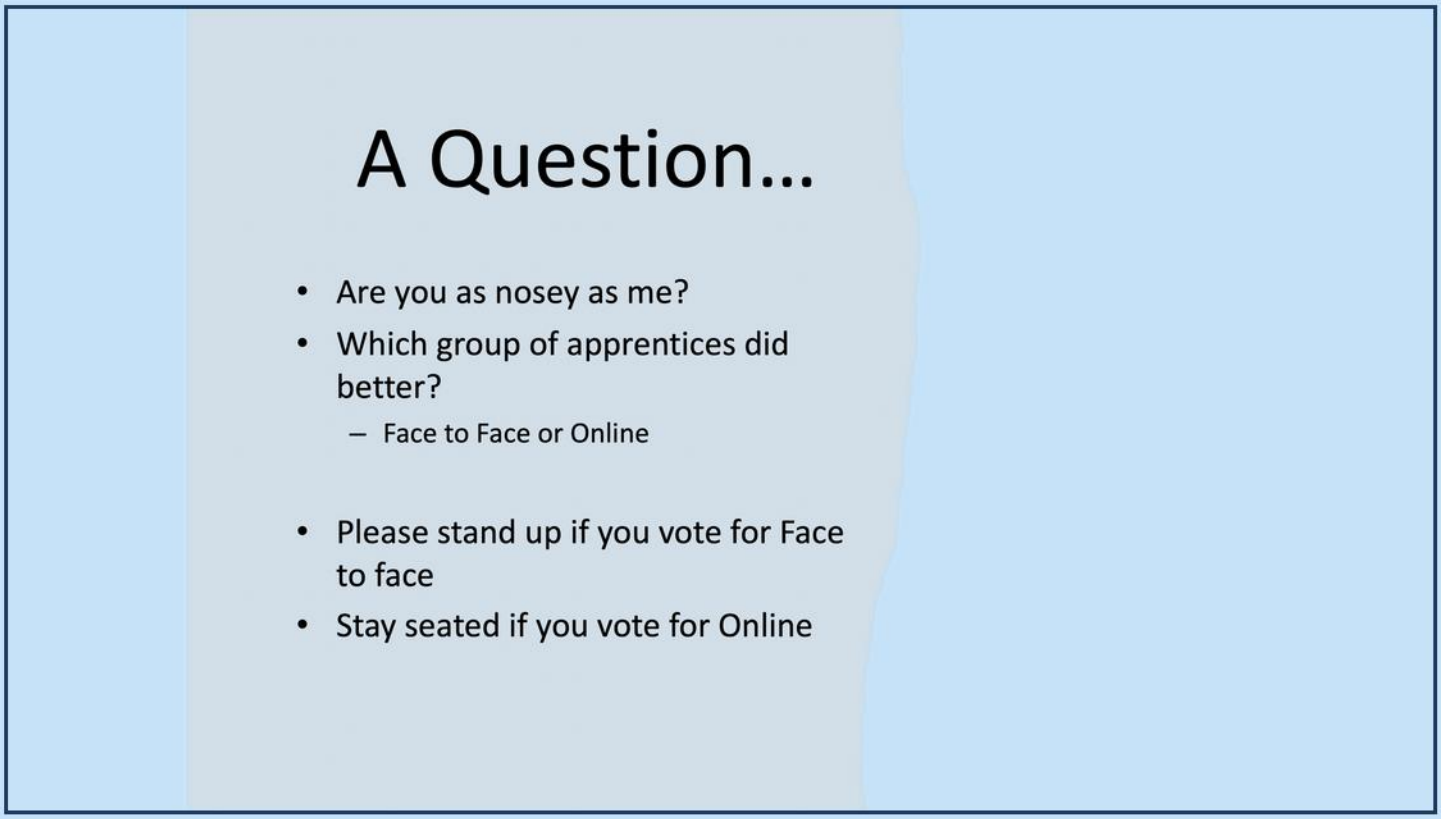


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Research Through an Inclusion Lens
- Level 7 research exploring apprentice experiences
- Focus on experiences within HyFlex learning
- Adult learners balance work, study and personal responsibilities
- Examined barriers and enablers of success

Facilitator Note: Summarise methodology, participants and purpose.
Explain the inclusion lens and adult learner context.

Case Study B (2/6): A Question… Face to Face or Online?



Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- A Question…
- Are you as nosey as me?
- Which group of apprentices did better? Face to Face or Online
- Please stand up if you vote for Face to face
- Stay seated if you vote for Online

Facilitator Note: Invite the room to vote physically: stand up if you think Face-to-Face apprentices performed better, or stay seated if you think Online apprentices performed better.

Case Study B (3/6): Research Findings — Learning Environments & Ecology



The result: Adult learners thrive in either setting in Hyflex, due to the ecology we create. Safety, security and compassion foster safe learning, secure knowledge transfer and compassionate academic Assistant Practitioners

Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- My research suggests that:
- Adult learners rarely fail in isolation.
- Their success is shaped by the environments we create.
- The result: Adult learners thrive in either setting in Hyflex, due to the ecology we create. Safety, security and compassion foster safe learning, secure knowledge transfer and compassionate academic Assistant Practitioners

Facilitator Note: Share the core research finding: adult learners rarely fail in isolation—their success is shaped by the environments we create. In HyFlex, adult learners thrive in either modality when safety, security, and compassion anchor the learning ecology.

Case Study B (4/6): Three Lessons for Inclusive Adult Learning

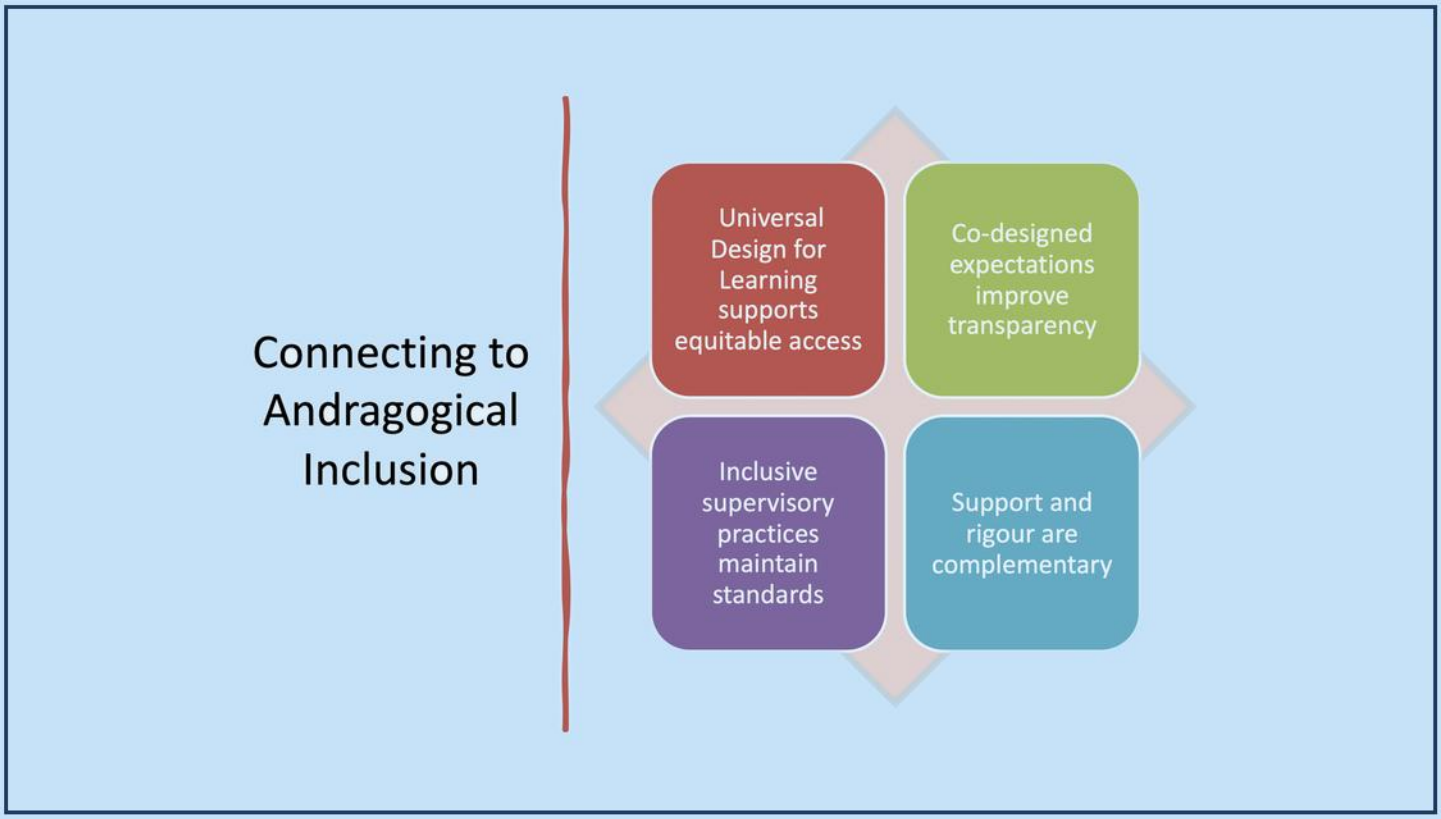


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Three Lessons for Inclusive Adult Learning
- 1. Belonging enables participation
- 2. Clarity reduces hidden barriers
- 3. Support strengthens rigour
- Engagement is shaped by the learning environment.

Facilitator Note: Discuss belonging, clarity and support. Emphasise these are conditions that enable participation and success. From interview, establish a connection, ask questions beyond the standard (are there children at home, who is able to support you at work and at

Case Study B (5/6): Connecting to Andragogical Inclusion

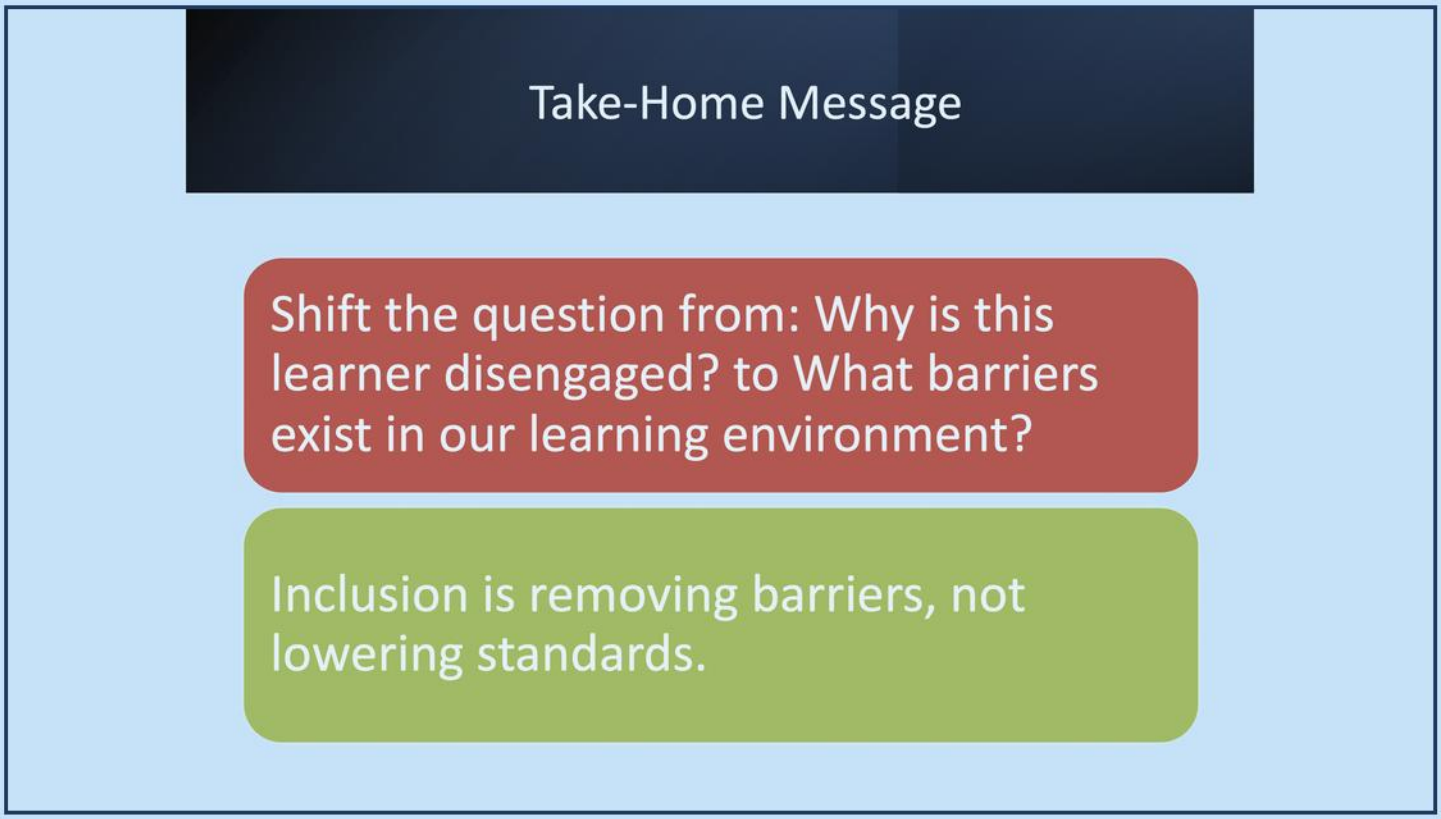


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Connecting to Andragogical Inclusion
- Universal Design for Learning supports equitable access
- Co-designed expectations improve transparency
- Inclusive supervisory practices maintain standards
- Support and rigour are complementary

Facilitator Note: Link findings to UDL, HyFlex approaches and co-designed norms. Highlight equity without compromising standards.

Case Study B (6/6): Take-Home Message

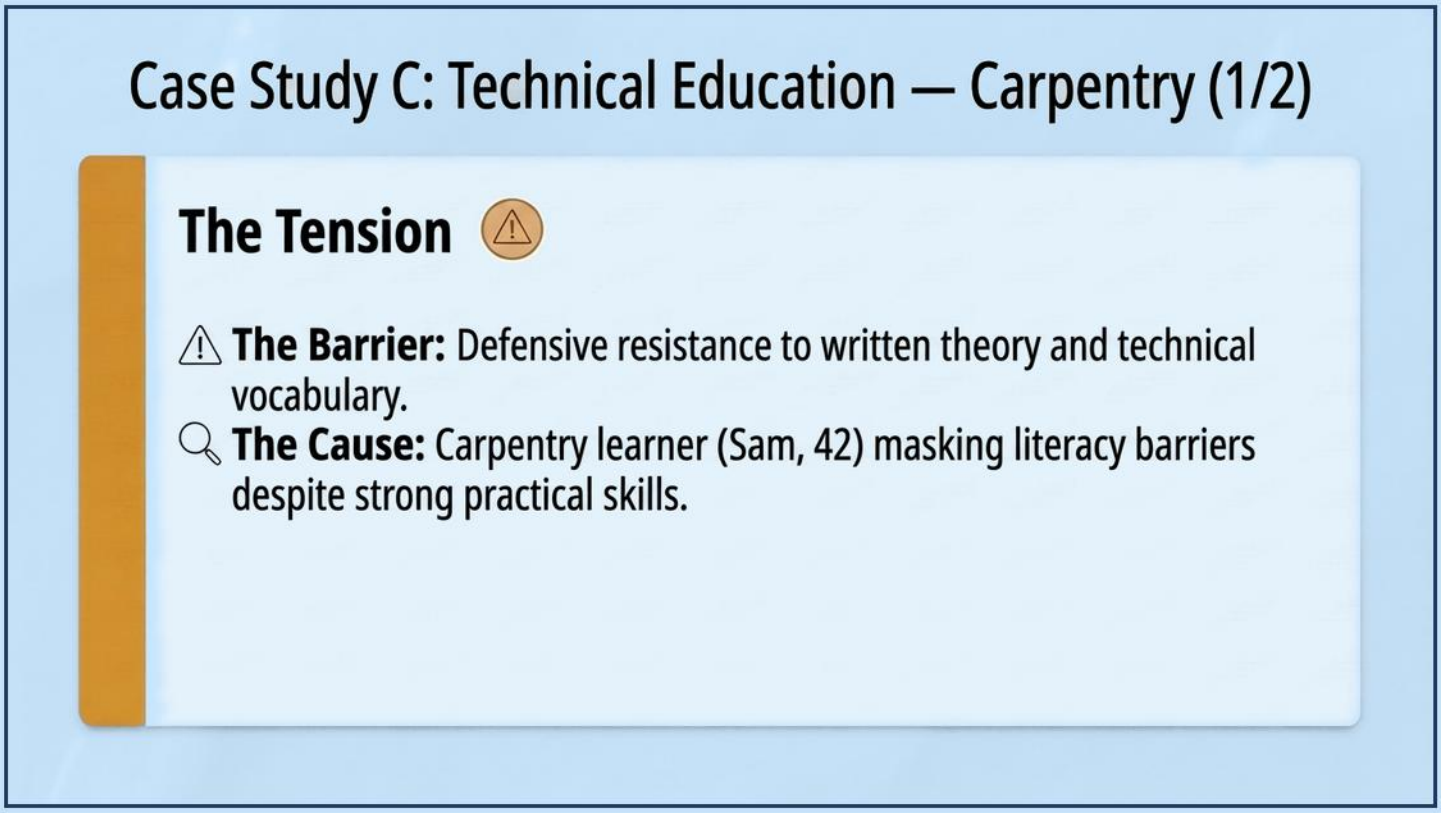


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Take-Home Message
- Shift the question from: Why is this learner disengaged? to What barriers exist in our learning environment?
- Inclusion is removing barriers, not lowering standards.

Facilitator Note: Leave audience with reflective questions and a strong concluding message about inclusion and academic rigour: shift from 'Why is this learner disengaged?' to 'What barriers exist in our learning environment?' Inclusion is removing barriers, not lowering

Case Study C: Technical Education — Carpentry (1/2) — The Tension

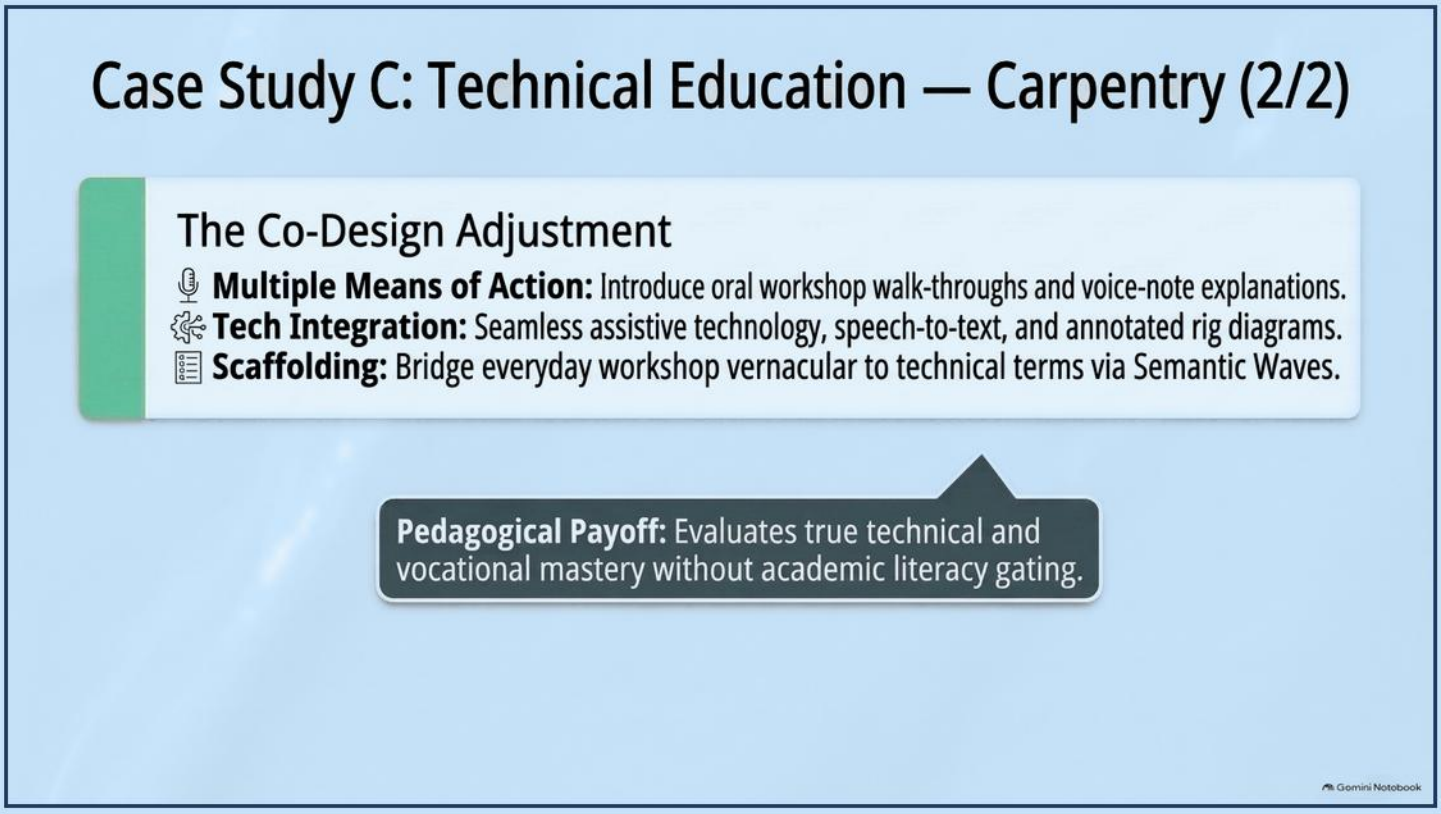


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Case Study C: Technical Education — Carpentry (1/2)
- The Tension
- The Barrier: Defensive resistance to written theory and technical vocabulary.
- The Cause: Carpentry learner (Sam, 42) masking literacy barriers despite strong practical skills.

Facilitator Note: Case Study C (Part 1): Examine how adult trade and carpentry learners like Sam (42), who possess strong tacit workshop mastery, may mask technical literacy barriers behind resistance to written theory.

Case Study C: Technical Education — Carpentry (2/2) — Co-Design & Payoff



Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Case Study C: Technical Education — Carpentry (2/2)
- The Co-Design Adjustment
- Multiple Means of Action: Introduce oral workshop walk-throughs and voice-note explanations.
- Tech Integration: Seamless assistive technology, speech-to-text, and annotated rig diagrams.
- Scaffolding: Bridge everyday workshop vernacular to technical terms via Semantic Waves.
- Pedagogical Payoff: Evaluates true technical and vocational mastery without academic literacy gating.

Facilitator Note: Case Study C (Part 2): Separating technical competence from immediate written prose—via oral rig walk-throughs, assistive speech-to-text, and Semantic Wave scaffolding—evaluates true vocational mastery rigorously.

Semantic Waves (LCT): Tacit-to-Explicit Bridging (1/3) — The Scenario: Sam, 42

Semantic Waves (LCT): Tacit-to-Explicit Bridging (1/3)

The Scenario: Sam, 42



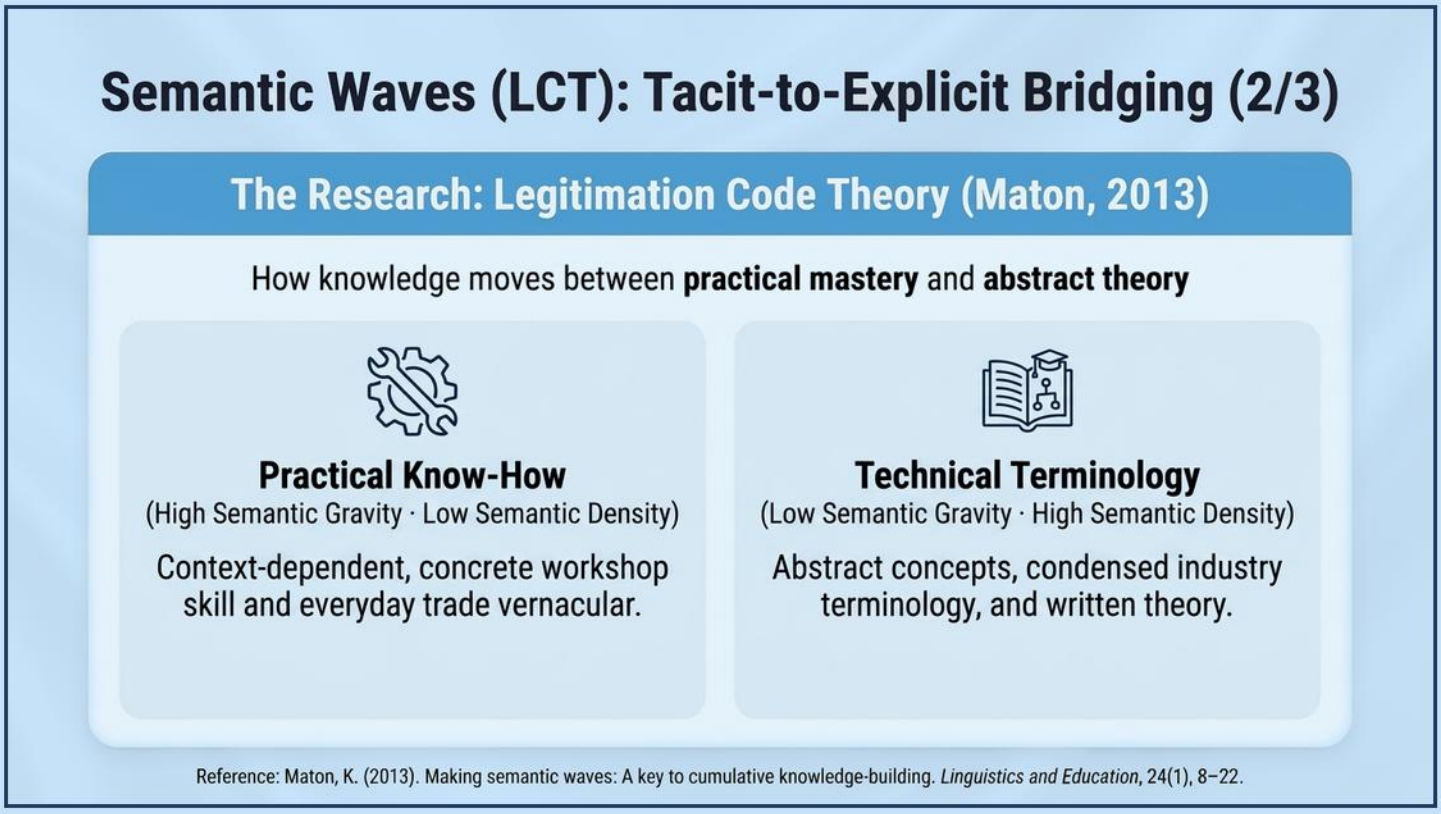
- **Context:** Retraining in Technical Education (Carpentry) while working.
- **Strength:** Strong tacit, hands-on practical know-how on the workshop floor.
- **Barrier:** Less confident with technical vocabulary and formal written explanations.

Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Semantic Waves (LCT): Tacit-to-Explicit Bridging (1/3)
- The Scenario: Sam, 42
- Context: Retraining in Technical Education (Carpentry) while working.
- Strength: Strong tacit, hands-on practical know-how on the workshop floor.
- Barrier: Less confident with technical vocabulary and formal written explanations.

Facilitator Note: Semantic Waves (Part 1/3): Introduce Sam (42), an experienced adult retraining in Technical Education (Carpentry) while working. Highlight the contrast between his strong tacit workshop mastery and his lower confidence with technical vocabulary and formal

Semantic Waves (LCT): Tacit-to-Explicit Bridging (2/3) — Legitimation Code Theory (Maton, 2013)

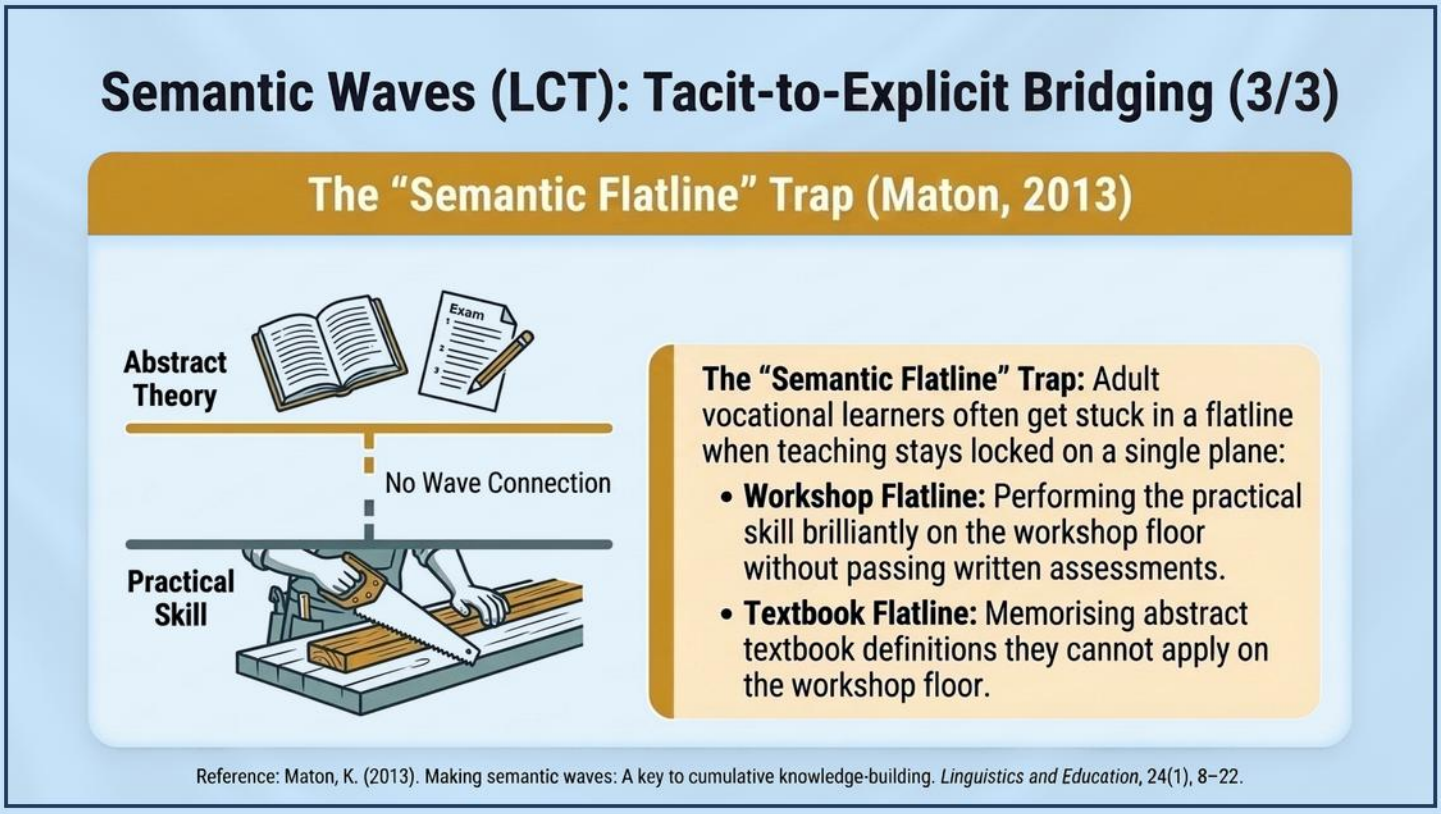


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Semantic Waves (LCT): Tacit-to-Explicit Bridging (2/3)
- The Research: Legitimation Code Theory (Maton, 2013)
- How knowledge moves between practical mastery and abstract theory
- Practical Know-How (High Semantic Gravity · Low Semantic Density): Context-dependent, concrete workshop skill and everyday trade vernacular.
- Technical Terminology (Low Semantic Gravity · High Semantic Density): Abstract concepts, condensed industry terminology, and written theory.
- Reference: Maton, K. (2013). Making semantic waves: A key to cumulative knowledge-building. Linguistics and Education, 24(1), 8–22.

Facilitator Note: Semantic Waves (Part 2/3): Unpack Karl Maton's (2013) Legitimation Code Theory (LCT)—contrasting Practical Know-How (high semantic gravity, low semantic density) with Technical Terminology (low semantic gravity, high semantic density).

Semantic Waves (LCT): Tacit-to-Explicit Bridging (3/3) — The “Semantic Flatline” Trap

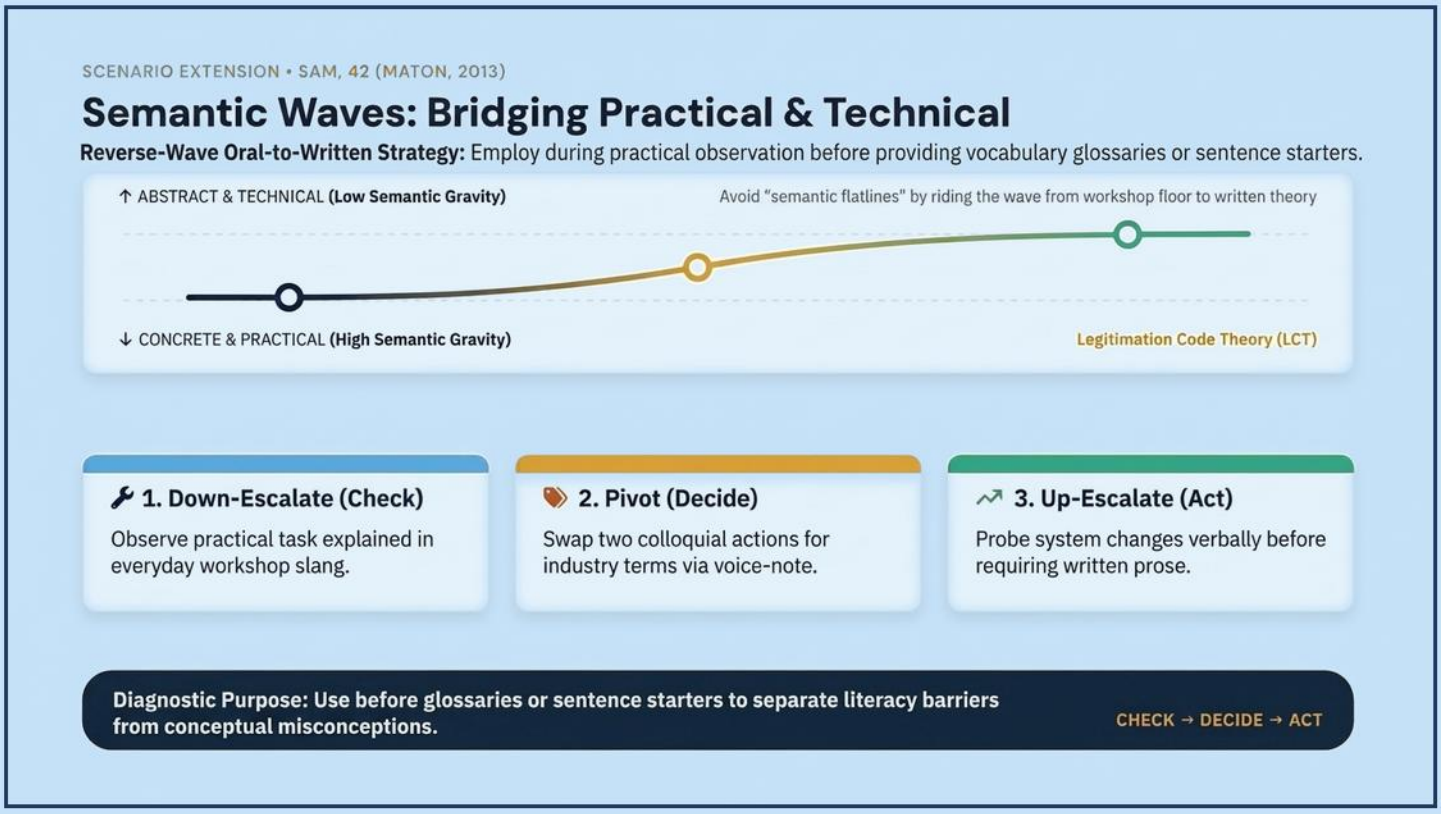


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Semantic Waves (LCT): Tacit-to-Explicit Bridging (3/3)
- The “Semantic Flatline” Trap (Maton, 2013)
- Abstract Theory vs. Practical Skill — No Wave Connection
- The “Semantic Flatline” Trap: Adult vocational learners often get stuck in a flatline when teaching stays locked on a single plane:
- Workshop Flatline: Performing the practical skill brilliantly on the workshop floor without passing written assessments.
- Textbook Flatline: Memorising abstract textbook definitions they cannot apply on the workshop floor.
- Reference: Maton, K. (2013). Making semantic waves: A key to cumulative knowledge-building. Linguistics and Education, 24(1), 8–22.

Facilitator Note: Semantic Waves (Part 3/3): Examine the 'Semantic Flatline' Trap—where teaching remains locked on one plane with no wave connecting Abstract Theory and Practical Skill. Learners get caught either in a Workshop Flatline (performing the practical skill

Semantic Waves: Bridging Practical & Technical

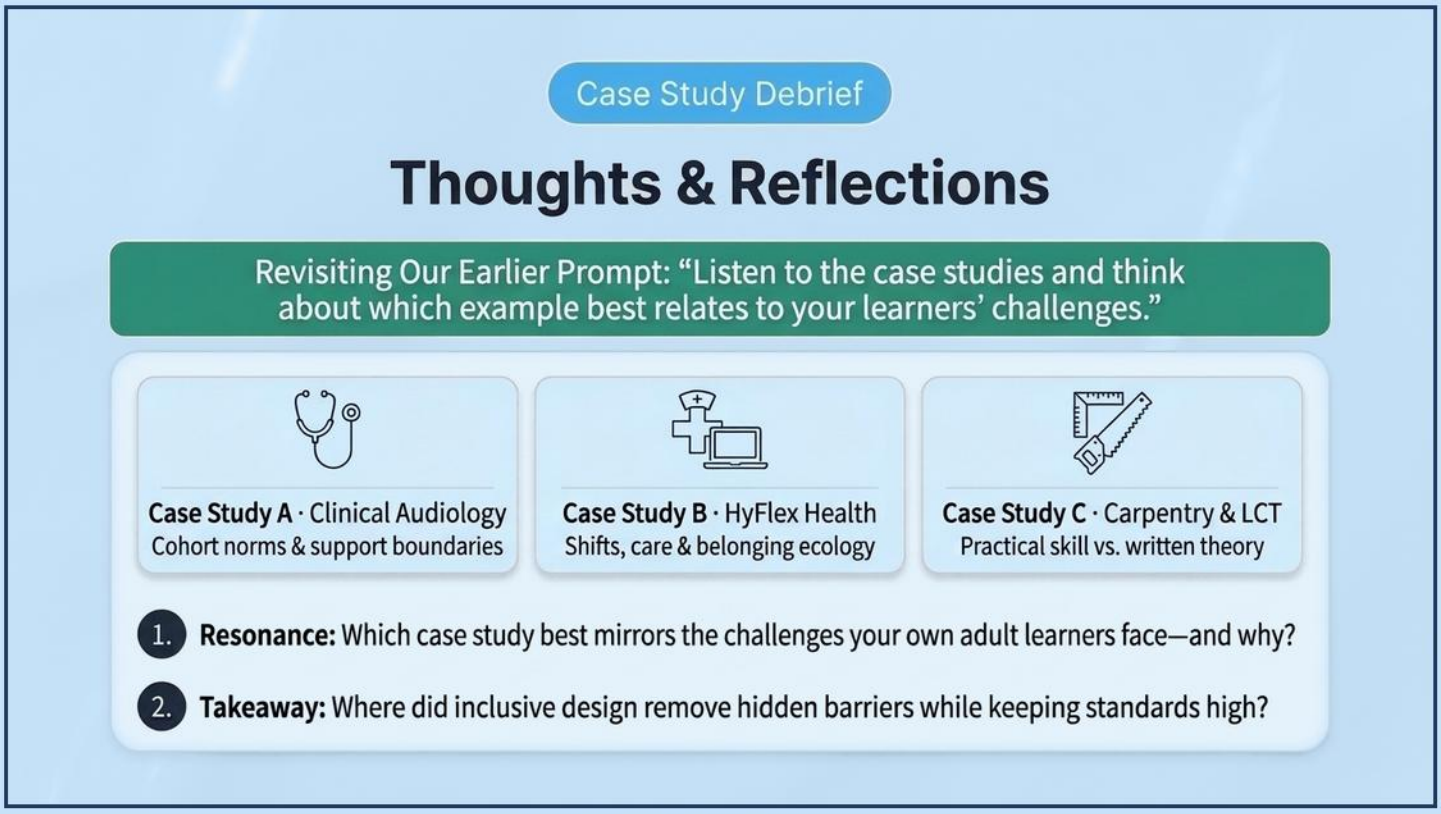


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- SCENARIO EXTENSION • SAM, 42 (MATON, 2013)
- Semantic Waves: Bridging Practical & Technical
- Reverse-Wave Oral-to-Written Strategy: Employ during practical observation before providing vocabulary glossaries or sentence starters.
- ABSTRACT & TECHNICAL (Low Semantic Gravity) — Avoid 'semantic flatlines' by riding the wave from workshop floor to written theory — CONCRETE & PRACTICAL (High Semantic Gravity) — Legitimation Code Theory (LCT)
- 1. Down-Escalate (Check): Observe practical task explained in everyday workshop slang.
- 2. Pivot (Decide): Swap two colloquial actions for industry terms via voice-note.
- 3. Up-Escalate (Act): Probe system changes verbally before requiring written prose.
- Diagnostic Purpose: Use before glossaries or sentence starters to separate literacy barriers from conceptual misconceptions. CHECK → DECIDE → ACT

Facilitator Note: Walk through the visual Semantic Wave progression for Sam (42), employed during practical observation before handing out vocabulary glossaries or sentence starters: starting with high semantic gravity on the workshop floor (1. Down-Escalate / Check),

Thoughts & Reflections — Case Study Debrief

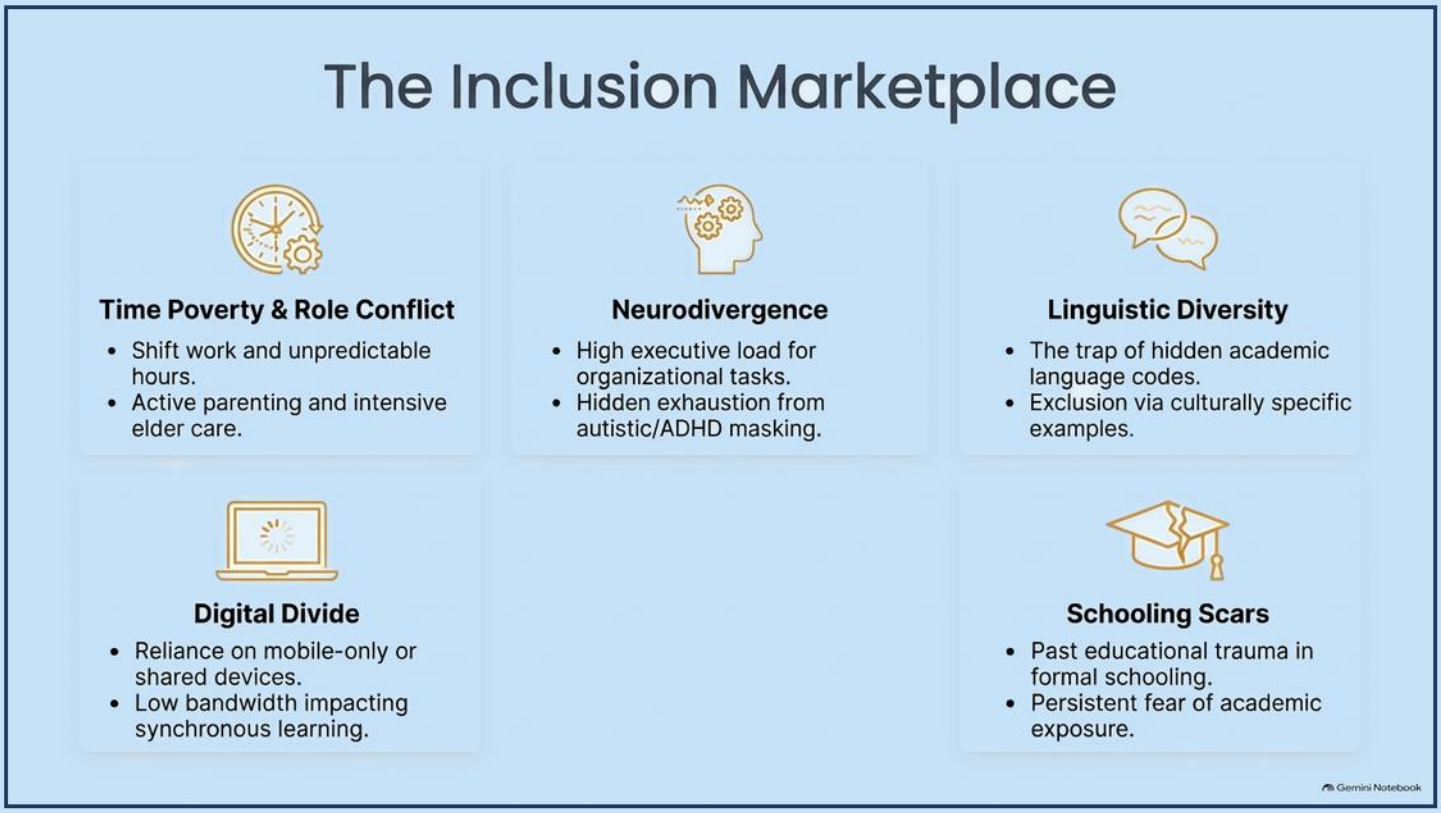


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Case Study Debrief
- Thoughts & Reflections
- Revisiting Our Earlier Prompt: "Listen to the case studies and think about which example best relates to your learners' challenges."
- Case Study A · Clinical Audiology — Cohort norms & support boundaries
- Case Study B · HyFlex Health — Shifts, care & belonging ecology
- Case Study C · Carpentry & LCT — Practical skill vs. written theory
- 1. Resonance: Which case study best mirrors the challenges your own adult learners face—and why?
- 2. Takeaway: Where did inclusive design remove hidden barriers while keeping standards high?

Facilitator Note: Pause for a 3–5 minute paired or whole-room reflection closing the loop on Slide 8's listening prompt ('Listen to the case studies and think about which example best relates to your learners' challenges.'). Invite colleagues to share which lived-

The Inclusion Marketplace: 5 Adult Learning Barriers

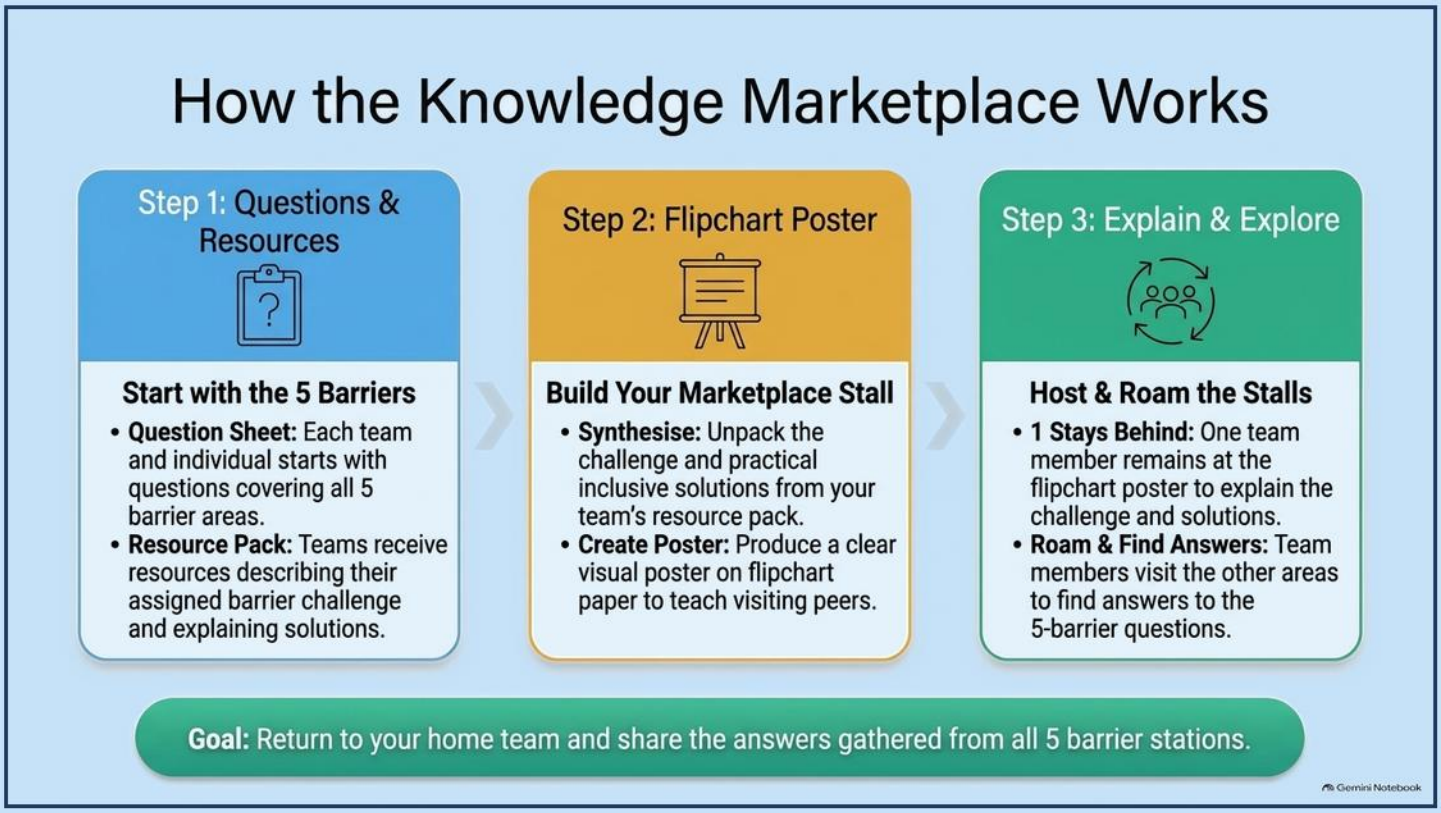


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- The Inclusion Marketplace
- Time Poverty & Role Conflict: Shift work and unpredictable hours; Active parenting and intensive elder care.
- Neurodivergence: High executive load for organizational tasks; Hidden exhaustion from autistic/ADHD masking.
- Linguistic Diversity: The trap of hidden academic language codes; Exclusion via culturally specific examples.
- Digital Divide: Reliance on mobile-only or shared devices; Low bandwidth impacting synchronous learning.
- Schooling Scars: Past educational trauma in formal schooling; Persistent fear of academic exposure.

Facilitator Note: Frame these five barrier areas not as student deficits, but as structural interfaces. Every barrier represents an institutional design challenge that thoughtful pedagogy and Universal Design can solve.

How the Knowledge Marketplace Works

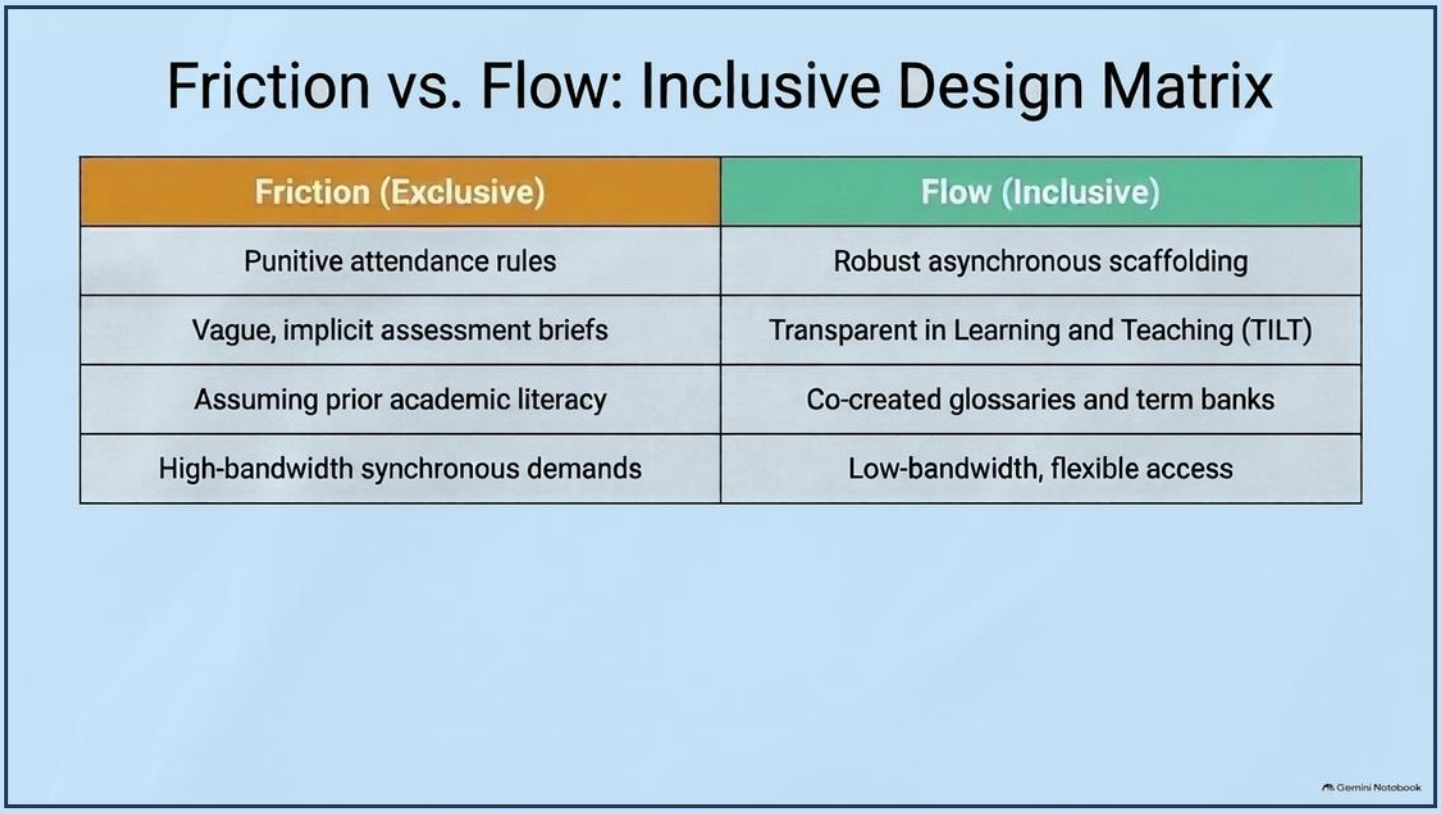


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- How the Knowledge Marketplace Works
- Step 1: Questions & Resources — Start with the 5 Barriers: Question Sheet: Each team and individual starts with questions covering all 5 barrier areas. Resource Pack: Teams receive resources describing their assigned barrier challenge and explaining solutions.
- Step 2: Flipchart Poster — Build Your Marketplace Stall: Synthesise: Unpack the challenge and practical inclusive solutions from your team's resource pack. Create Poster: Produce a clear visual poster on flipchart paper to teach visiting peers.
- Step 3: Explain & Explore — Host & Roam the Stalls: 1 Stays Behind: One team member remains at the flipchart poster to explain the challenge and solutions. Roam & Find Answers: Team members visit the other areas to find answers to the 5-barrier questions.
- Goal: Return to your home team and share the answers gathered from all 5 barrier stations.

Facilitator Note: Walk participants through the three-step Knowledge Marketplace protocol: (1) review the 5-barrier question sheet and team resource pack, (2) create a flipchart poster explaining the challenge and its solutions, and (3) leave one stallholder behind to teach

Friction vs. Flow: Inclusive Design Matrix

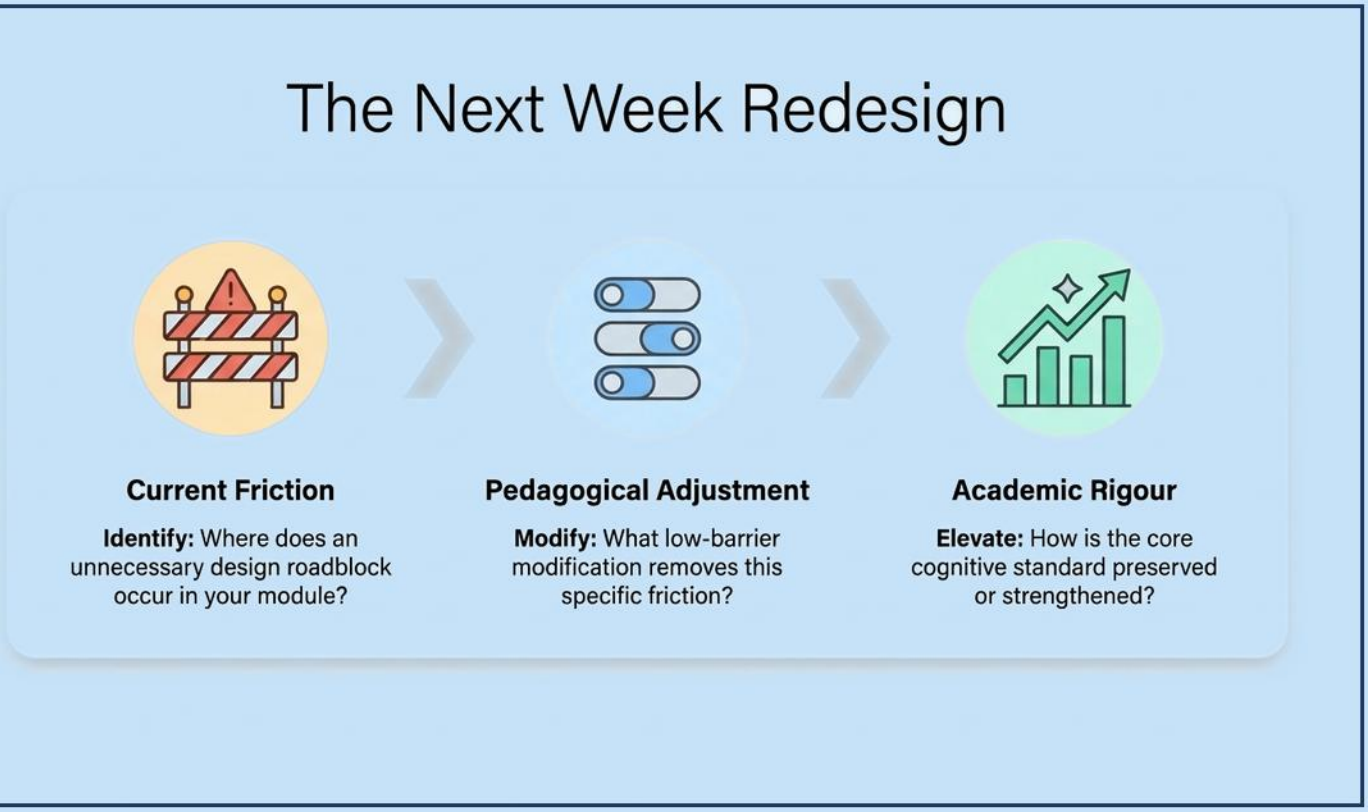


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Friction vs. Flow: Inclusive Design Matrix
- Punitive attendance rules vs. Robust asynchronous scaffolding
- Vague, implicit assessment briefs vs. Transparent in Learning and Teaching (TILT)
- Assuming prior academic literacy vs. Co-created glossaries and term banks
- High-bandwidth synchronous demands vs. Low-bandwidth, flexible access

Facilitator Note: Review the side-by-side contrast between exclusive institutional friction and inclusive pedagogical flow before launching the 15-minute Marketplace station rotation.

The Next Week Redesign

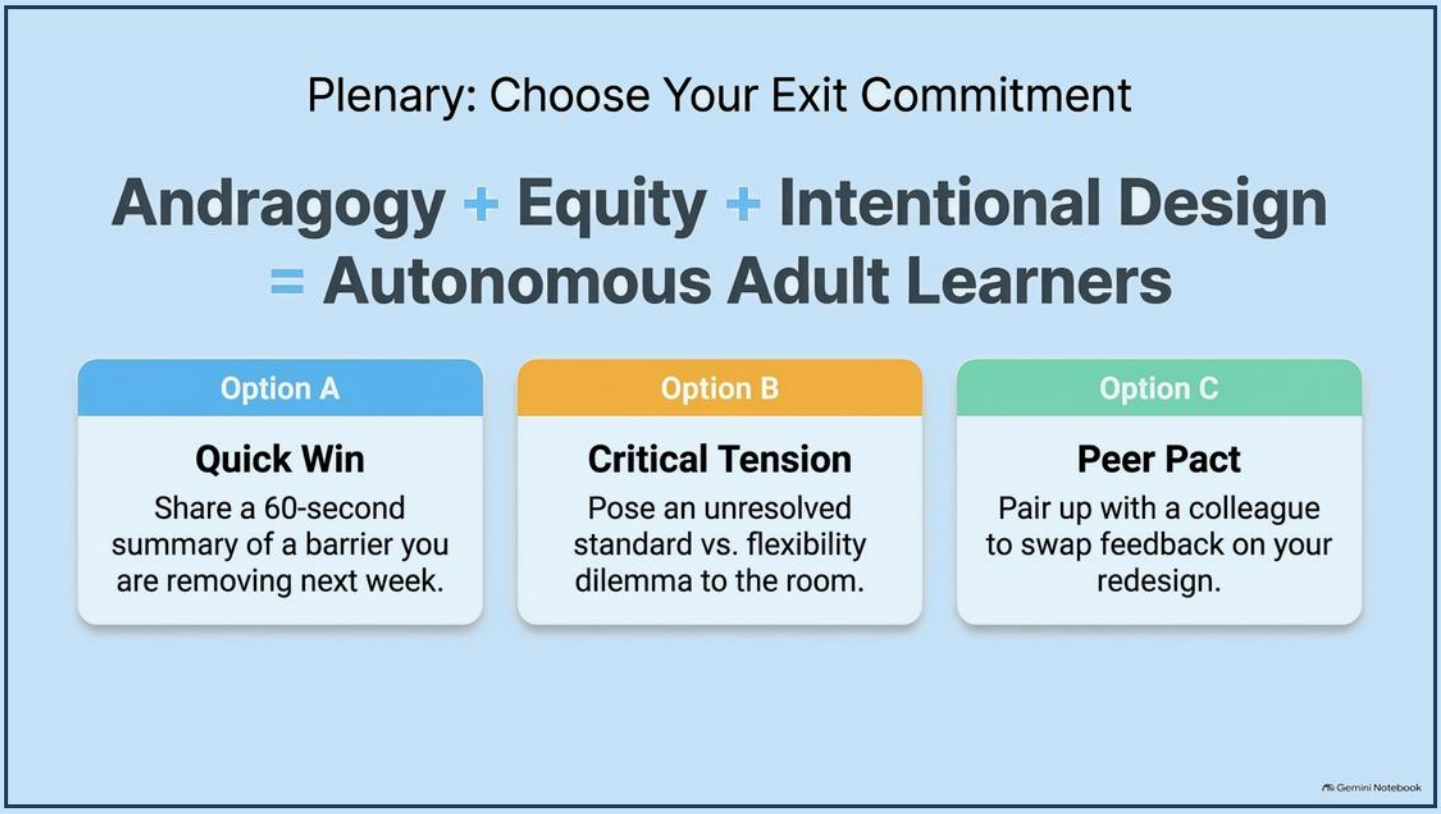


Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- The Next Week Redesign
- Current Friction — Identify: Where does an unnecessary design roadblock occur in your module?
- Pedagogical Adjustment — Modify: What low-barrier modification removes this specific friction?
- Academic Rigour — Elevate: How is the core cognitive standard preserved or strengthened?

Facilitator Note: No one leaves with abstract theory. This three-step redesign sequence bridges today's professional dialogue directly into next week's teaching.

Plenary: Choose Your Exit Commitment



Key Concepts & Slide Transcript:

- Plenary: Choose Your Exit Commitment
- Andragogy + Equity + Intentional Design = Autonomous Adult Learners
- Option A — Quick Win: Share a 60-second summary of a barrier you are removing next week.
- Option B — Critical Tension: Pose an unresolved standard vs. flexibility dilemma to the room.
- Option C — Peer Pact: Pair up with a colleague to swap feedback on your redesign.

Facilitator Note: Thank colleagues for their vulnerability and expertise. Remind everyone that inclusive andragogy is not an endpoint or checklist—it is an ongoing scholarly discipline practiced in community.